

1961

Chicago Police Board

The Chicago Police Board was founded following the 1960 Summerdale scandal, where eight officers were caught running a burglary ring. [SOURCE](#)

1974

Office of Professional Standards

OPS is founded a year after a 1973 panel initiated by U.S. Rep. Ralph Metcalfe finds systemic abuse. OPS is a civilian-staffed misconduct unit but housed inside CPD. [SOURCE](#)

2007

IPRA replaces OPS

After mounting evidence that OPS shielded officers in shooting cases, the city dissolves it and creates the Independent Police Review Authority outside CPD. [SOURCE](#)

2016

COPA created

A task force report concludes CPD has “no regard for the sanctity of life when it comes to people of color.” On Oct. 5, 2016, the Council replaces IRPA with the Civilian Office of Police Accountability (COPA) to provide more transparency and independence in investigating police misconduct. [SOURCE](#)

2019

Federal consent decree in force

A consent decree is entered in federal court and takes effect under U.S. District Judge Robert M. Dow Jr.. An independent monitoring team begins semi-annual compliance reports. [SOURCE](#)

2021

Empowering Communities for Public Safety

The City Council passes the Empowering Communities for Public Safety Ordinance 36–13. It creates a seven-member Community Commission with power over CPD policy, plus 22 resident-elected District Councils — three per police district. [SOURCE](#)

2024

Commissioners seated

The District Councils nominate and Mayor Brandon Johnson appoints the first permanent seven-member Community Commission, made up of civilians. [SOURCE](#)